



53 KG

SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

ANTIM PANGHAL

As the reigning World No. 1 in her weight category, expectations are high from Antim Panghal to improve on the bronze medal she won at Hangzhou. Since winning that medal at the age of 19, Antim (**in pic, red**) has gained considerably more experience. She has also won two world championship medals and also competed at the Olympics.

She will also be itching to prove herself after shockingly failing to qualify for the Asian Championships earlier this year. The entry list makes clear how difficult the road to gold will be for Antim, though. China's Asian champion Zhang Jin will pose a real threat, as will Japan's Moe Kiyooka, former world champion at 55kg. North Korea's Choe Hyo-gyong, a bronze medallist from the Paris Games and the 2025 World Championships, also looms on the horizon.

On her day, Antim has the ability to beat any of these wrestlers. She has shown as much in the past. Zhang might be the reigning Asian champion, but Antim has a close win over her at last year's World Championships, en route to her bronze-medal finish.